Allah’s Name: Al-‘Adl (العدل)

The Most Just

A simple lesson for children

What does Al-‘Adl mean?

Al-‘Adl means “The Most Just.” Allah is perfectly fair. He gives every person what is right. He never makes a wrong choice, and He never treats anyone badly.

Sometimes we do not understand why something happens. But Muslims believe that Allah knows everything: what we can see and what we cannot see. Allah knows every person’s actions, feelings, needs, and situation. So His judgment is always fair.

What we learn from this name

- Allah does not wrong anyone—not even a tiny bit.
- Allah knows every good thing we do, even a small act that other people do not notice.
- Allah knows when someone has been treated badly.
- Allah tells us not to oppress people. To oppress means to hurt someone, take their right, cheat them, or treat them unfairly.
- We should try to be fair at home, at school, and with friends.

Words from the Qur’an and Hadith

Qur’an 10:44

“Allah does not wrong people at all, but people wrong themselves.”
(Simple meaning: Allah is never unfair to people.)

Hadith Qudsi (Sahih Muslim)

Allah says: “My servants, I have made oppression forbidden for Myself and forbidden among you, so do not oppress one another.”
(Simple meaning: Allah is never unfair, and He tells us not to be unfair to each other.)

A true story about fairness

Long before Prophet Muhammad ﷺ became a prophet, the people of Makkah rebuilt the Ka‘bah. When it was time to put the Black Stone back in its place, different tribes argued. Every tribe wanted the honor of doing it. The argument became very serious.

The people agreed to let Muhammad ﷺ decide, because they trusted him. He gave a fair idea. He put the Black Stone on a cloth. A leader from each tribe held one side of the cloth. They lifted it together. Then Muhammad ﷺ put the Black Stone in its place.

This was a fair solution. No tribe was left out, and no tribe got all the honor alone. The argument ended peacefully.

Important: This story is about the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ showing fairness. Allah is Al-‘Adl, perfectly just. We try to learn fairness because Allah loves justice and tells us not to oppress anyone.

How can I be fair?

- If two children want the same game, take turns or make a fair plan.
- Do not blame someone before you hear both sides of the story.
- Do not cheat in a game or take something that is not yours.
- Share fairly when you can.
- Say sorry and fix the problem if you have treated someone unfairly.
- Speak kindly for someone who is being treated badly.

Think about it

Imagine that you and your brother or sister each get one piece of cake. What would be fair? If one person did more work to make the cake, should you listen to both people before deciding? Being fair means thinking carefully and giving people their rights.

Questions

1. What does the name Al-‘Adl mean?

Answer:

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2. Does Allah ever treat anyone unfairly?

Answer:

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3. What does it mean to oppress someone?

Answer:

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4. What did the tribes disagree about in the story?

Answer:

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5. How did Prophet Muhammad ﷺ solve the problem fairly?

Answer:

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6. Tell one way you can be fair at home, at school, or with a friend.

Answer:

Teacher's short answer guide

- 1. Al-'Adl means The Most Just, or perfectly fair.
- 2. No. Allah never treats anyone unfairly.
- 3. It means treating someone badly or unfairly, such as hurting, cheating, or taking their right.
- 4. They disagreed about who would put the Black Stone back in the Ka'bah.
- 5. He asked leaders from the tribes to lift it together on a cloth, then he placed it in its place.
- 6. Answers will be different. Examples: taking turns, sharing, not cheating, or listening to both sides.

Sources for the teacher

Qur'an 10:44; Sahih Muslim, Book of Virtue, Hadith 2577 (also numbered 6246 in some editions); accounts of the Black Stone dispute in books of Seerah (the Prophet's biography).